

Release Guide



Fix Version 3.4.0.

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Overview

The following releases notes are a high-level reflection of work completed during Fix Version 3.4.0. These include both clients facing and back-end updates.

The main areas of focus for this release are as follows:

- Germany API
- Deviations and Previous Periods
- Annual Returns

1. Germany API

1.1. Overview

The Comply updates to navigate the API Submission flows for Germany. This includes:

- Authentication and Data Validation responses from the Tax Authority.
- Successful Submission flow.
- Failed Submission Flow
- On-Screen Pop Ups
- Email Notifications
- Submission Results
- Audit History

1.2. Configuration

1.2.1. Select Submitter Information

Here in the Jurisdiction Details page, you can set the Filer Type. This setting will decide the XML template which will be generated, as there are different templates with specific fields required for each submitter type.

The screenshot displays the 'Jurisdiction Details' page for Germany. The page has a header with 'Group Name' (DE-2-22 > Germany) and a search bar. The main content area is divided into three columns. The first column, 'View Details', contains 'VAT Number' (DE1224543) and 'VAT Registration Type' (a dropdown menu). The second column, 'Fixed Establishment Address Details', contains 'Street Number' and 'Street Name' (both text input fields). The third column, 'Fiscal Representative Details', contains 'Name' and 'VAT Number' (both text input fields). A red rectangular box highlights the 'Submitter Information' section, which is located at the top of the first column. This section contains the 'Filer Type' label and two options: 'Entrepreneur' (checked with a green checkbox) and 'Foreign Entrepreneur' (unchecked with a grey checkbox). Below these options is a checkbox labeled 'Tick if you are filing on your own behalf as an Entrepreneur'.

The options here are:

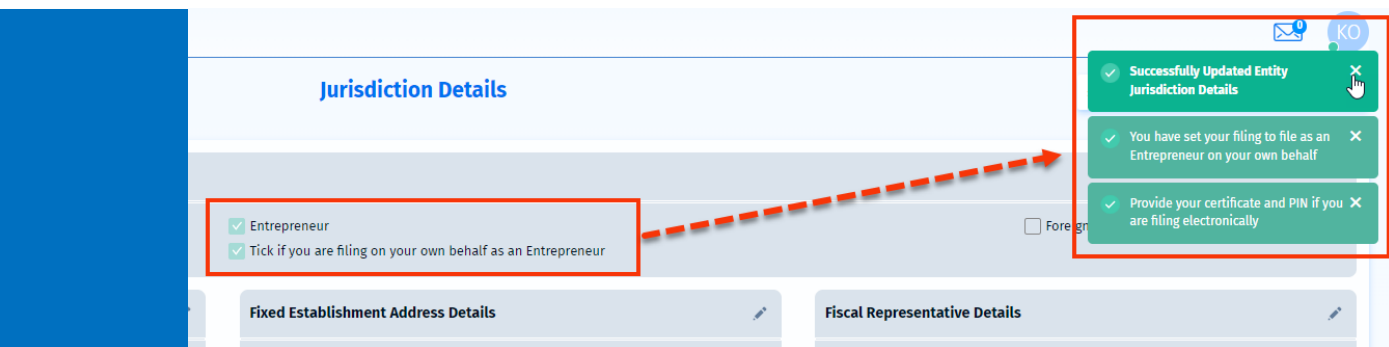
Filer Type	Description
Entrepreneur	A Tax Consultant filing for you.
Filing on your own behalf	You are filing on your own behalf.
Foreign Entrepreneur	A Foreign Tax Consultant is filing on your behalf.

Please note: By default, this section is set to **Entrepreneur**.

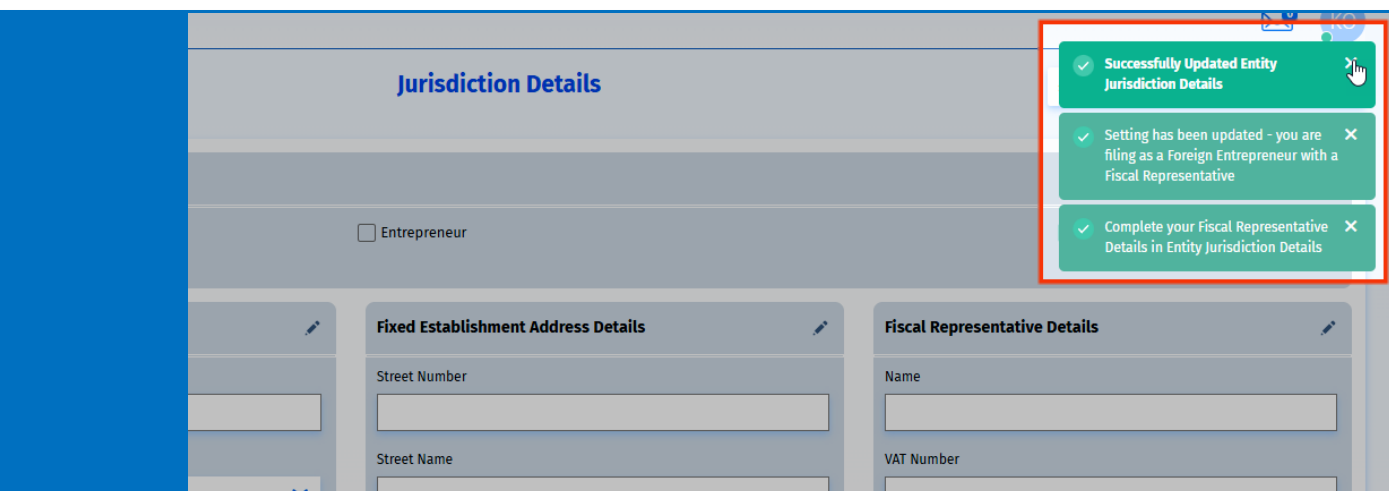
1.2.2. Changing the Default Submitter Type

If you change the submitter type, you must click Save at the bottom on the screen, at which point you will receive the following notification pop-ups.

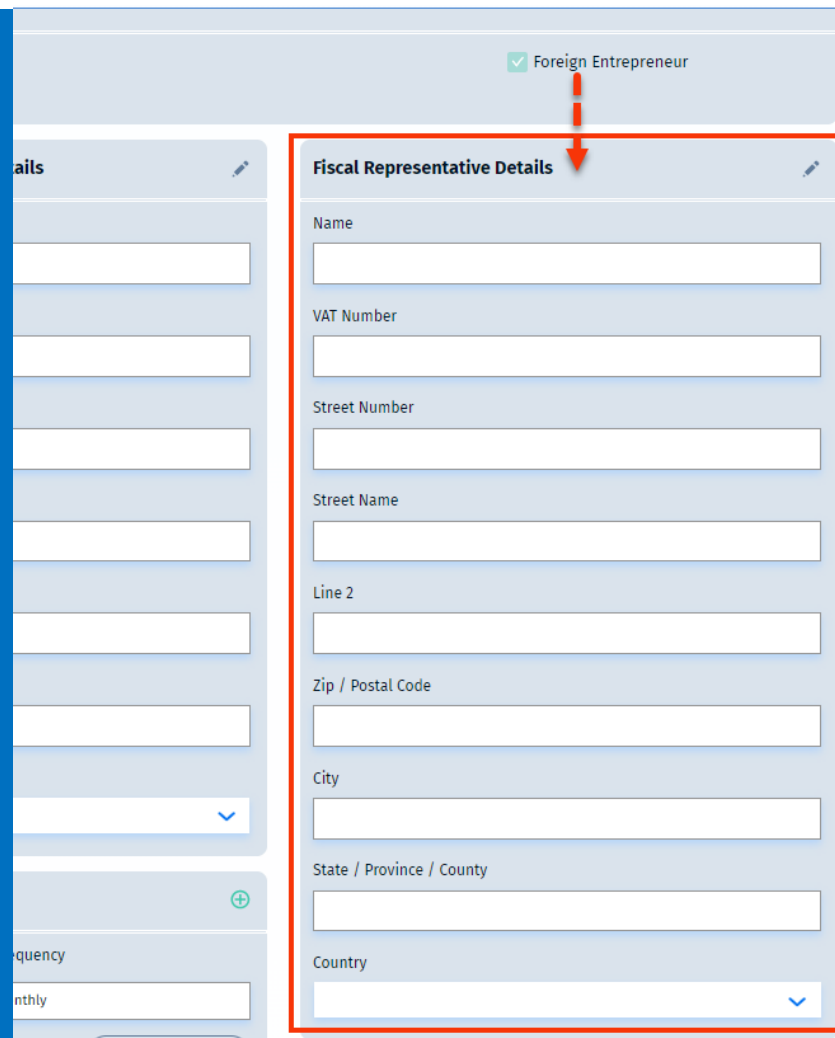
File as an Entrepreneur on your own behalf:



Foreign Entrepreneur:



Please note: If you select the **Foreign Entrepreneur** option, then you are required to complete the **Fiscal Representative Details** section on screen.



The screenshot shows a web form interface. At the top, there is a checkbox labeled "Foreign Entrepreneur" which is checked. A red arrow points from this checkbox down to the "Fiscal Representative Details" section. This section is highlighted with a red border and contains the following fields:

- Name
- VAT Number
- Street Number
- Street Name
- Line 2
- Zip / Postal Code
- City
- State / Province / County
- Country

To the left of the "Fiscal Representative Details" section, there is a sidebar with a "Details" section containing several empty input fields and a dropdown menu. Below this, there is a "Frequency" section with a dropdown menu set to "Monthly".

1.3. Submission Flow

The Submission flow starts when the user clicks **Submit** on any Return with a Status of “To Submit”.

Return 210

Jurisdiction	Entity	Type	Frequency	Period	Status	Filing Deadline
Germany	DE-2-22	VAT Return	Monthly	Jun 2023	To Submit	2023-07-10

Next action due by 2023-07-10

Return Timeline • Audit History • 4 Comments • 0

Files Data Validation Transactions Return Validation Return Review

Return Boxes Submission Results

English Local language

Section	Description	Original Value	Submitted Value	Previous Period	Deviations	Previous Year	Attachments
Box 81 Net	Vat rate 19% (Taxable Amount Without VAT)						
Box 81 Vat	Vat rate 19% (Tax)						
Box 86 Net	Vat rate 7% (Taxable Amount Without VAT)						
Box 86 Vat	Vat rate 7% (Tax)						
Box 87	Vat rate of 0%						
Box 35	other Vat rates (Taxable Amount Without VAT)						

RETURN "TO PREPARE" CREATE RETURN BOXES VIEW RETURN SUBMIT

1.3.1. Tax Authority Authentication

After clicking Submit, the TAX Authority perform their own Authentication process. This validates the correct Certificate/PIN/Password combination is in place.

In the case where neither a Certificate and/or Password have been added to your entity, then the following will be displayed on the return (For Preparer/Reviewer & Approver).

Return 145

Jurisdiction	Entity	Type	Frequency	Period	Status	Filing Deadline
Germany	DE-2-22	VAT Return	Monthly	Aug 2024	Data Due	2024-09-10

Next action due by 2024-09-03

Return Timeline • Audit History • 0 Comments • 0

⚠ A Certificate file and a PIN is required to submit the return electronically. Please contact your administrator to add these details for filing electronically.

Files Data Validation Transactions Return Validation Return Review

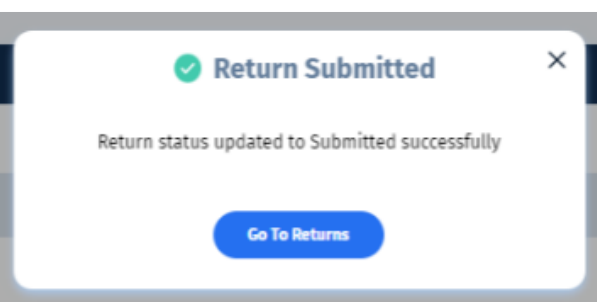
1.3.2. [Tax Authority Data Validation](#)

The Tax Authority will then validate the return against their own requirements. Depending on the result of this validation, the submission will be either:

- Confirmed as Successful
- Failed with an Error

1.3.3. [Successful Submission](#)

The following pop-up message is displayed when the return is filed successfully.

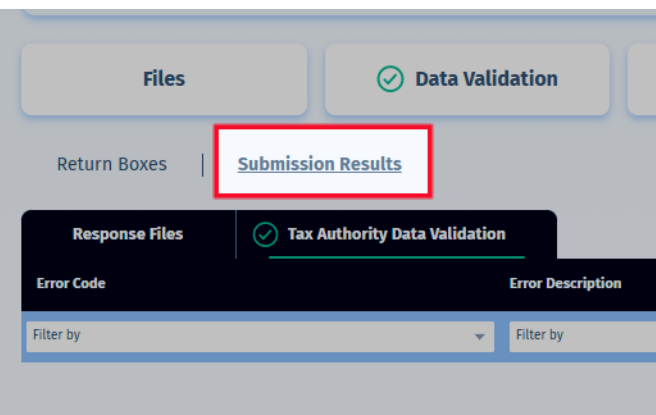


At this stage, the status on the return changes to “**Submitted.**” The **Go To Returns** button will direct the user back to the All Returns screen.

Submission Results

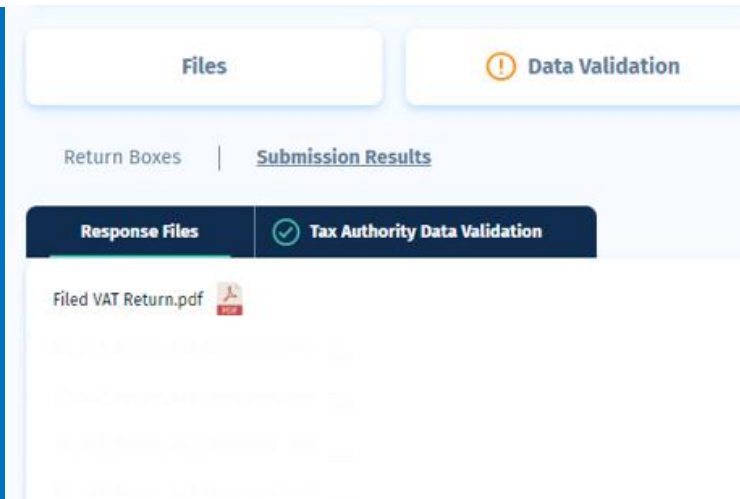
A new **Submission Results** tab is available on the Return Review screen. This includes:

- Response Files
- Tax Authority Data Validation



Response File

When a return is successfully submitted and passes both Tax Authority Authentication & Tax Authority Data Validation, then a response file (PDF) is populated here. This is the PDF file of the successful return from the TAX Authority.



This PDF will be labelled based on the Return Type and will automatically download the file when clicked.

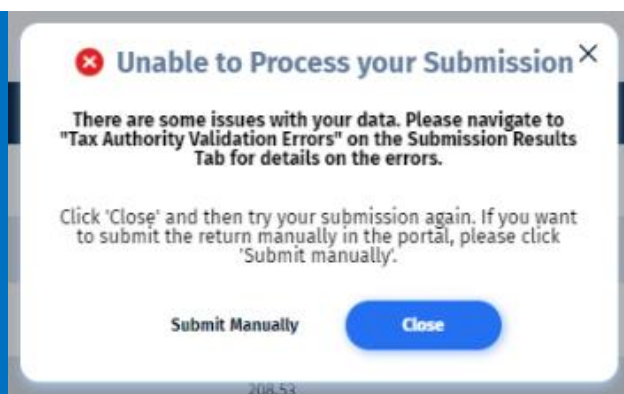
1.3.4. Failed Submission

There may be many reasons why the return fails the validation process, but in all cases, an error will be displayed on Comply explaining and providing basic instruction.

Several actions are triggered **simultaneously**:

- **Error Message**

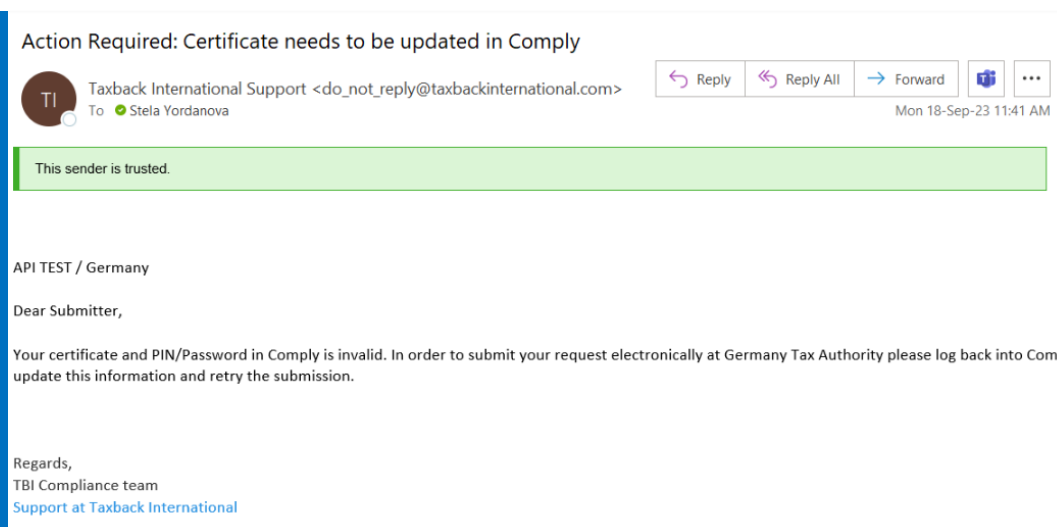
The following generic error will be displayed.



This message identifies that there are issues with the data submitted which have failed the Tax Authorities Data Validation.

- **Email**

The following Email is sent to the Preparer/Reviewer/Submitter.



- **Submission Results**

A Validation result will be populated in Submission Results tab on the Return Review screen.

The Tax Authority Data Validation tab will display a red warning tag, and a new row will be added below outlining:

- Error Code
- Error Description

1.3.5. Return to “To Prepare”

If required, The Return to “To Prepare” button is displayed on the following Statuses:

- To Submit
- Submission Failed

This will allow the user to bring the status back to “To Prepare” and make any relevant changes.

Example: Submission Failed

The screenshot displays the 'Return 209' interface. At the top, a summary bar shows: Jurisdiction (Germany), Entity (DE-2-22), Type (VAT Return), Frequency (Monthly), Period (May 2023), Status (Submission Failed), and Filing Deadline (2023-06-12). Below this, a navigation bar includes buttons for Files, Data Validation (with a green checkmark), Transactions, Return Validation, and Return Review. A red dashed arrow points from the 'Submission Failed' status to the 'Return to TO PREPARE' button located at the bottom left of the interface. The main content area shows a table of 'Numerical Boxes' with columns for Section, Description, Original Value, Submitted Value, Previous Period, Deviations, Previous Year, and Attachments. The table lists several VAT-related boxes (Box 81 Net, Box 81 Vat, Box 86 Net, Box 86 Vat, Box 87, Box 35) with values of 0.00. At the bottom right, there are buttons for 'CREATE RETURN BOXES', 'VIEW RETURN', and 'SUBMIT'.

Section	Description	Original Value	Submitted Value	Previous Period	Deviations	Previous Year	Attachments
Box 81 Net	Vat rate 19% (Taxable Amount Without VAT)	0.00	0.00	0		0	
Box 81 Vat	Vat rate 19% (Tax)	0.00	0.00	0		0	
Box 86 Net	Vat rate 7% (Taxable Amount Without VAT)	0.00	0.00	0		0	
Box 86 Vat	Vat rate 7% (Tax)	0.00	0.00	0		0	
Box 87	Vat rate of 0%	0.00	0.00	0		0	
Box 35	other Vat rates (Taxable Amount Without VAT)	0.00	0.00	0		0	

1.3.6. Audit History

Once the user clicks Submit on a Return, Comply keeps an Audit History of each step in the process.

The screenshot displays the 'Audit History' section of the Comply interface. At the top, a summary bar shows return details: Jurisdiction (Germany), Entity (DE-2-22), Type (VAT Return), Frequency (Monthly), Period (Mar 2023), Status (Submission Failed), and Filing Deadline (2023-04-11). Below this, a red box highlights the 'Audit History' link in the navigation bar. A red dashed arrow points from this link to the 'Audit History' section below. The 'Audit History' section has tabs for 'All Logs', 'Return Logs', and 'Transaction Logs'. Below the tabs is a table with columns: Date, Event Group, Event Change (From/To), User, and Comment. The table contains several rows of status change logs, all performed by Keith O'Sullivan. A red box highlights the first row of the table. At the bottom, there are 'Prev', 'Next', and 'View by' (15, 30, 50) buttons.

Date	Event Group	Event Change (From/To)	User	Comment
22/09/2023 13:44:06	Return Status Change	status - Submitting / status - Submission Failed	Keith O'Sullivan	610201106 - eSigner: Es wurde ein falsches Pa
22/09/2023 13:44:02	Return Status Change	status - Submission Failed / status - Submitting	Keith O'Sullivan	
22/09/2023 12:53:42	Return Status Change	status - Submitting / status - Submission Failed	Keith O'Sullivan	610201106 - eSigner: Es wurde ein falsches Pa
22/09/2023 12:53:42	Return Status Change	status - To Submit / status - Submitting	Keith O'Sullivan	
22/09/2023 12:51:44	Return Status Change	status - To Approve / status - To Submit	Keith O'Sullivan	
22/09/2023 12:51:40	Return Status Change	status - To Review / status - To Approve	Keith O'Sullivan	
22/09/2023 12:51:36	Return Status Change	status - To Prepare / status - To Review	Keith O'Sullivan	
22/09/2023 12:50:52	Return Status Change	status - Submission Failed / status - To Prepare	Keith O'Sullivan	
22/09/2023 12:49:34	Return Status Change	status - Submitting / status - Submission Failed	Keith O'Sullivan	610201106 - eSigner: Es wurde ein falsches Pa

E.g., Each step is logged here automatically, including:

- The Date and Timestamp
- The change/process recorded.
- The username
- The comment/description – this may include the error in case of a failed submission.

2. Deviations & Previous Periods

2.1. Overview

The Numerical Boxes now include relevant previous period data. This is used as a visual comparison with previous periods which allows the user to make informed decisions relating to the current return.

2.1.1. New Columns

This includes the following new columns which have been added to the Numerical Boxes:

Section	Description	Original Value ⓘ	Submitted Value ⓘ	Previous Period ⓘ	Deviations ⓘ	Previous Year ⓘ	Attachments
Box 1	Acts and transactions subject to tax at a rate of 20%	78,500.43	78,500.43	-9106.09		-9271.64	
Box 2	Acts and transactions subject to tax at a rate of 9%	108,671.76	108,671.76	91799.47	↑ 18.38%	83845.93	
Box 2.1	Acts and transactions subject to tax at a rate of 5%	77,711.15	77,711.15	55276.8	↑ 40.59%	0	
Box 3	Acts and transactions subject to tax at a rate of 0%, incl.	1,284,561.70	1,284,561.70	420	↑ 305748.02%	420	
	Intra-Community supply of goods and services						

Colum	Description
Previous Period	This displays the values from the previous return.
Deviations	This displays deviations of the current month compared with the previous month.
Previous Year	This displays the values from the same period of the previous year.
Attachments	The ability to attach supporting files which help provide clarity on the deviations (PDF, Word, Xls, Xlxs, JPEG, PNG, or copies of emails on a numerical return box).

2.1.2. Column Headers

The user can hover over each column header for more information on what the column displays:

Previous Period ⓘ	Deviations ⓘ	Previous Year ⓘ	Attachments
-9106.09	Values from the previous return	-9271.64	
91799.47	↑ 18.38%	83845.93	
55276.8	↑ 40.59%	0	
420	↑ 305748.02%	420	

2.1.3. Previous Period

This column displays the value from the Submitted Value from the previous return.

Current Return

Previous Period ⓘ	Deviations ⓘ	Previous Year ⓘ	Attachments
-9106.09		-9271.64	
91799.47	↑ 18.38%	83845.93	
55276.8	↑ 40.59%	0	

Previous Return (5686)

Submitted Value ⓘ		Previous Period ⓘ	Deviations ⓘ	Previous Year
-9,106.09		-9206.09		
91,799.47		91639.47	↑ 0.17%	
55,276.80		55166.8	↑ 0.2%	

2.1.4. Deviations

The Deviations column displays a % fluctuation (Positive/Negative) of the current month compared to the previous month. It is also colour coded.

Previous Period ⓘ	Deviations ⓘ	Previous Year ⓘ
-9106.09		-9271.64
91799.47	↑ 18.38%	83845.93
55276.8	↑ 40.59%	0
420	↑ 305748.02%	420

2.1.5. Previous Year

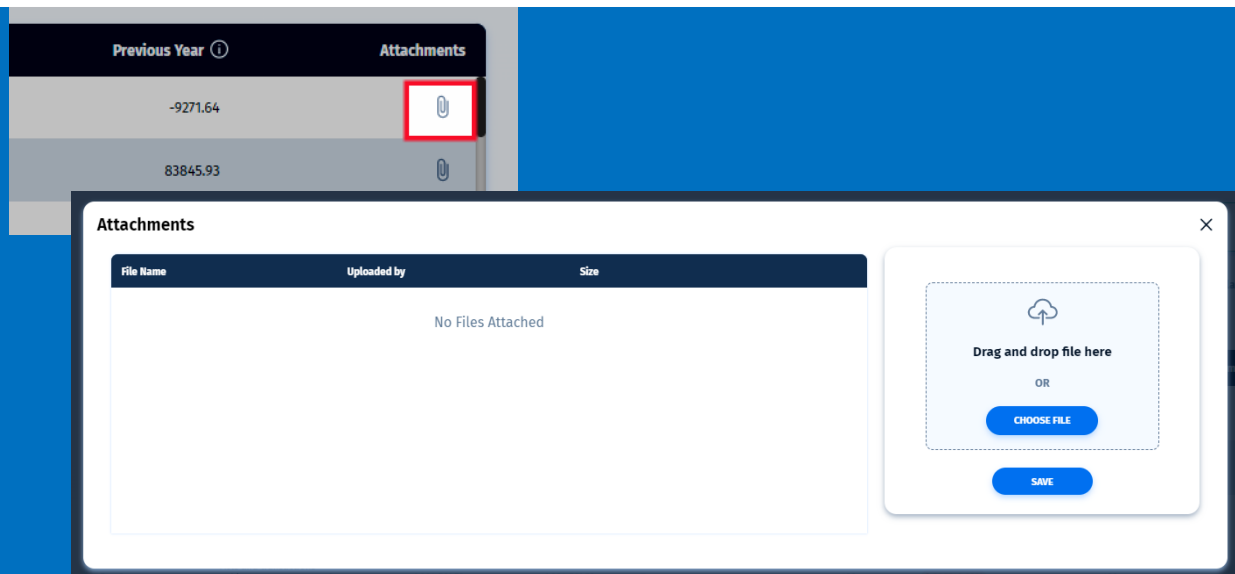
This Column displays the Submitted Values from the same period, but from the previous year.

E.g., The submitted values figure from Jan 2022 are populated in the Previous Year field for the Jan 2023 return.

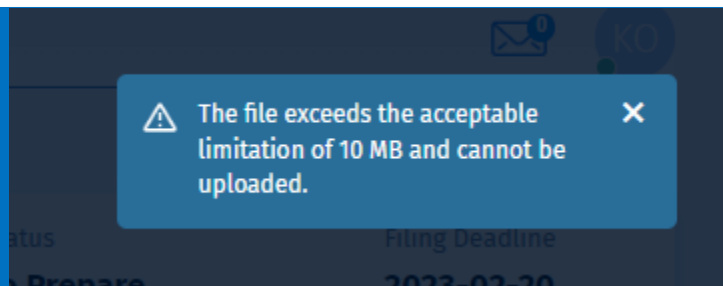
Previous Period ⓘ	Deviations ⓘ	Previous Year ⓘ	Attachments
-9106.09		-9271.64	
91799.47	↑ 18.38%	83845.93	
55276.8	↑ 40.59%	0	
420	↑ 305748.02%	420	

2.1.6. Attachments

This allows the user to add/view supporting files to add clarity around the deviation.



Please note: A max limit of 10 MB is placed on file uploads.



3. Annual VAT Returns (Germany)

Processing of Annual VAT Returns is not available in Comply.

3.1. Return Boxes

Once the data file has been uploaded and processed, the return boxes are generated and available in the Return Review screen.

Return 171

Jurisdiction: **Germany** Entity: **DE-1-11** Type: **Annual VAT Return** Frequency: **Annually** Period: **Jan-Dec 2022** Status: **Submitted** Filing Deadline: **2023-07-31**

Next action due by 2023-07-31 Return Timeline • Audit History • 20 Comments • 0

Files Data Validation Transactions Return Validation **Return Review**

[Return Boxes](#) | Submission Results English Local language

Section	Description	Original Value ⓘ	Submitted Value ⓘ
Box 238	Turnover in calendar year 2021	0.00	0.00
Box 239	Turnover in calendar year 2022	0.00	0.00
Box 177 Net	Sales at the general tax rate, deliveries and other services at 19%	0.00	0.00
Box 177 Vat	Sales at the general tax rate, deliveries and other services at 19%	0.00	0.00
Box 178 Net	Sales at the general tax rate Free value deliveries a) Deliveries according to § 3 paragraph 1b UStG at 19%	0.00	0.00
Box 178 Vat	Sales at the general tax rate Free value deliveries a) Deliveries according to § 3 paragraph 1b UStG at 19%	0.00	0.00

VIEW RETURN

3.2. Drop-down options for Non-Numerical Box 870

When a user is preparing an Annual VAT Return for Germany for 2022/2023, and the Non-Numerical Box 870 is displayed. This can be edited and displays a drop-down with the following options:

- Blank
- Yes
- No

The screenshot shows the 'Return Boxes' section of the Taxback software. The 'Non-Numerical Boxes' tab is active. A table lists various boxes with their descriptions and values. The 'Box 870' field is highlighted with a red box. It contains the question 'Was a VAT Refund Claim under 8th/13th Directive for 2019 lodged with BZSt?'. A dropdown menu is open, showing options: 'Yes', 'No', and 'blank'. The interface also includes a 'RETURN TO PREPARE' button and a 'SUBMIT' button.

Section	Description	Values	Edit	Audit History
Representative City *	City			
Representative Foreign Postcode *	Post code (foreign)			
Representative Post Office Box *	Post office box			
Representative Telephone *	Telephone			
Representative Email *	Email address			
Section 150 *	The VAT return is signed by the authorised representative. The requirements of section 150 (3) AG are met.			

Box 870 * Was a VAT Refund Claim under 8th/13th Directive for 2019 lodged with BZSt?

RETURN TO PREPARE

Yes
No
blank

SUBMIT

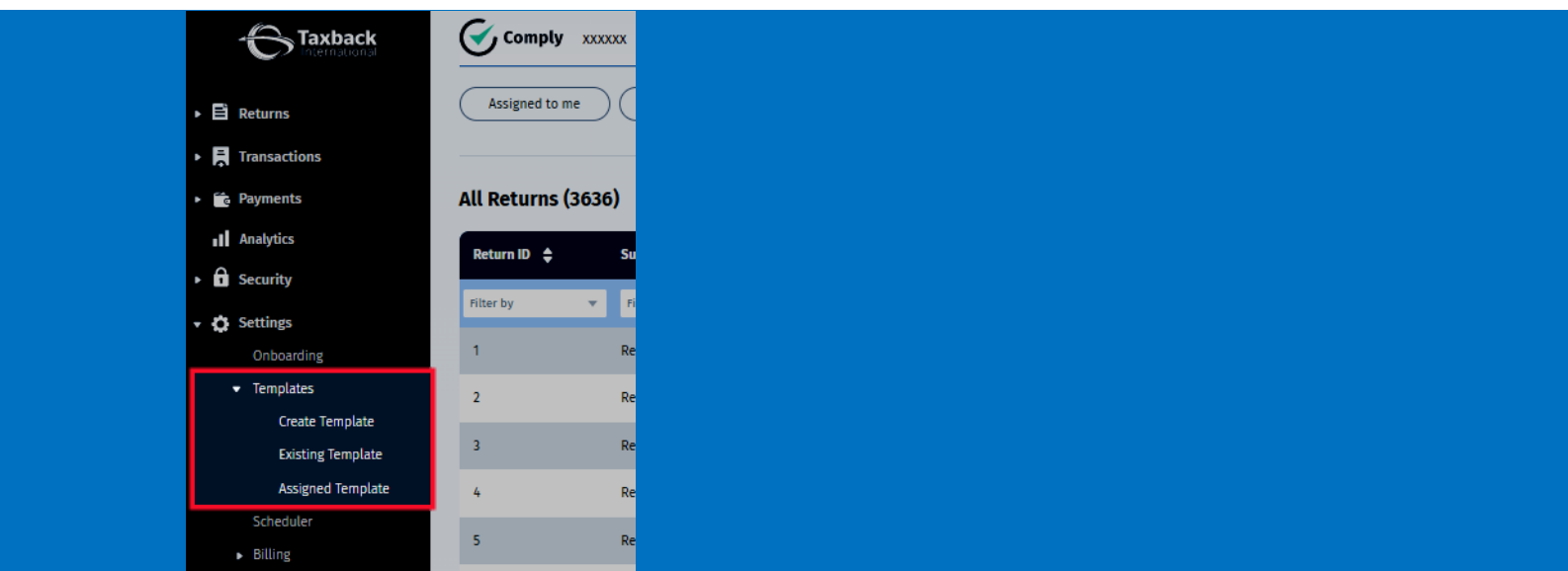
4. Additional Comply Updates

4.1. 50% Deductibility added to Italian Returns

When creating a Template for Italy, a new 50% option has been added to the Deductibility drop-down.

This can be added during Template creation or added retrospectively by navigating to:

Settings > Templates



On the **Map Tax Transaction Codes** section, make the selection in the **Deductibility** drop-down.

